18.4 AWS Fargate: Running containers without managing a cluster of virtual machines

Let’s take a little trip down AWS history lane. ECS has been generally available since 2015. Since its inception, ECS has been adding another layer to our infrastructures. With ECS you had to manage, maintain, and scale not only containers but also the underlying EC2 instances. This increased complexity significantly.

In November 2017, AWS introduced an important service: AWS Fargate. As shown in figure 18.5, Fargate provides a fully managed container infrastructure, allowing you to spin up containers in a similar way to launching EC2 instances. This was a game changer! Since then, we have deployed our workloads with ECS and Fargate whenever possible, and we advise you to do the same.